ENTERTAINMENT

THE STARS IN OUR EYES

*The **Bollywood Superstars** exhibition at the Louvre Abu Dhabi captures the journey of Indian films from a regional industry to a global phenomenon*







DEPARTMENT OF CULTURE AND TOURISM – ABU DHABI. PHOTO: ISMAIL NOOR/SEEING THINGS

Every Indian is defined by the films they grew up with. The larger-than-life tales, elaborate sets, stunning costumes and mesmerising song and dance routines are an intrinsic part of 'desi culture'.

Given the growing popularity in global circles, it is hardly surprising that Indian cinema has found its way to the iconic Louvre Abu Dhabi. *Bollywood Superstars: A Short Story of Indian Cinema* is the museum's newest temporary exhibition to enrapture viewers with the history of films in India. Featuring extracts from numerous films and artworks, the exhibition presents an opportunity to visitors to immerse themselves in Indian cinema.

They have hit the nail on the head with Jaya Bachchan from *Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham* (2001) greeting you at the entrance. From therein on, a range of loans highlight early storytellers' props, shadow puppets, photography, Mughal armour, daggers, mythological and religious lithographs.

From its humble beginnings in the 19th century, when traditional shadow theatre and early silent movies were popular forms of entertainment, it's spellbinding to note the evolution to cinema as we know it today, showcasing the subcontinent's diversity.

In less than a century, Indian cin-

DANCE

United We Dance

Dance group Quick Style are on their first trip to India, a country whose music has inspired their most viral moves



Norwegian hip-hop dance group Quick Style had choreographed for popular Korean band BTS and featured on US TV show *World of Dance*, but it was a 12-minute spirited jig to a Bollywood-Punjabi medley at a fellow member's wedding last year that propelled them to global stardom. Choreographed in a parking lot in Oslo on the day of the performance, Quick Style's Bilal Malik led other members in the mission to not disappoint his twin brother-groom, Suleman, also the group's chief choreographer. "Everything done with 100 per cent heart hits the heart," says Bilal. The steps to one of the tracks, 'Kala Chash-